

▽ Protesters surround Soviet tanks entering Prague



August 1968

CZECHOSLOVAKIA'S PRAGUE SPRING CRUSHED

The election of Alexander Dubček as head of the Czech Communist Party in January 1968 began a time of liberalization that soon attracted the hostility of the USSR. After seven months of mounting frustration the USSR took action, sending half a million troops into the country to restore the status quo. The action attracted worldwide criticism as well as fierce opposition within Czechoslovakia itself.

1968

2 March 1969

Chinese and Soviet troops clash on the Ussuri River border



△ Martin Luther King's funeral, Atlanta

4 April 1968

MARTIN LUTHER KING ASSASSINATED

As the most prominent leader of the US Civil Rights movement, Baptist minister Rev. Dr Martin Luther King Jr was a target for racist hostility. While visiting Memphis to support a local strike, he was killed by a single bullet fired by James Earl Ray, a career criminal with previous convictions for burglary and armed robbery. His death caused widespread shock and grief, and rioting broke out in many cities.

▷ Apollo 11 mission patch



1930-2012 NEIL ARMSTRONG

A one-time test pilot, Armstrong joined NASA's astronaut training programme in 1962. Four years later, he made his first spaceflight in the Gemini programme preceding Apollo. He retired from NASA in 1971 to take up a post teaching engineering.

▽ Neil Armstrong walks on the lunar surface

